THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** he was disciplined even in crime and driven by his hobby	A restrained, hobby-driven thief.
2	**(c)** Horace had planned the robbery for weeks.	had + V3.
3	**(d)** Horace deserved to be caught.	A judgement.
4	**(c)** an experienced criminal	She stayed in control.
5	**(b)** gullible	Gullible.
6	**(a)** Horace worked as a prison librarian.	Stated event.
7	**(a)** believe a stranger without checking	He trusted blindly.
8	**(a)** a kind of peaceful reward for Horace's love of books	Ironic comfort.
9	**(c)** an oxymoron	Contradictory pair.
10	**(b)** careless handling of evidence by Horace	He left traces.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He is polite and kindly (1) and her confident story gave no reason for doubt, yet a sensible thief would have been suspicious (1).	1+1
12	Horace finds a kind of reward in his punishment (1) because he can read the books he always loved (1).	1+1
13	She dresses the part and speaks with ease (1) and her request seems normal to a man who wants to be helpful (1).	1+1
14	He chooses the day when the house is empty (1) and prepares his tools and the safe's details (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A burglar who sneezes and helps a stranger is comic. The thief being robbed adds irony. The mild tone and ending in the library keep the story light.	1+1+1
16	He is a thief and breaks the law, so he is wrong. But he is gentle, polite and only steals for his love of books. The author treats him with humorous sympathy.	1+1+1
17	Although Horace was careful, he was caught. The conjunction shows contrast.	1+1+1
	OR: Publicly he is a respected lock-maker. Privately he is a thief who steals to feed his passion for rare books. The contrast makes him a rich comic character.	1+1+1
18	Horace is unlucky to meet a cleverer thief on his planned day. He is also lucky to get a peaceful job in the library. Luck gives the story its comic reversal.	1+1+1
	OR: Horace was caught because his fingerprints were found. He was fooled by the woman.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Humour in Horace's character (1). Irony of the thief tricked (1). The woman's cleverness (1). Moral: do not trust blindly (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address and date (1). Salutation (1). Account of events (1). Regret (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Horace: gentle, amateur, gullible (1). Woman: bold, professional, cunning (1). Their motives (1). Their outcomes (1). What the contrast shows (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Define irony (1). A thief robbed (1). A lock expert fooled (1). A prison gives joy (1). The effect on theme (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Horace Danby a professional thief; he is a **respectable locksmith** who steals once a year to buy rare books.
- Writing that Horace opened the safe at the Grange for his own plan; he opened it for the **young lady** who tricked him with a false story.
- Saying the lady was the owner's wife; she was a **thief** in disguise, while the real wife was a grey-haired woman of sixty.

- Missing the clue of his **fingerprints**: he took off his gloves to give her the lighter and opened the safe without them.
- Stating the title's meaning wrongly: the 'question of trust' is whether to trust a stranger; Horace trusted too easily and was *caught*.
- Spelling slips: *Horace Danby, locksmith, Shotover Grange, fingerprints, hay fever*; and 'honour among thieves'.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** the woman takes the jewels	The decisive event.
2	**(a)** relative clause	Who seemed calm.
3	**(c)** the woman had lied	She was not the owner's wife.
4	**(c)** misplaced trust	Trust.
5	**(b)** believable	Plausible = believable.
6	**(a)** gullible but gentle	Fits the story.
7	**(d)** Horace was deceived by the woman.	was + V3.
8	**(c)** plausible and delivered confidently	Plausibility.
9	**(c)** her ready story and confident manner	She improvised well.
10	**(a)** was happy and at ease	In his element = at ease.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	They were evidence of his presence (1) and let the police link him to the crime (1).	1+1
12	Horace's desire for rare books pushes him to steal (1) and the woman's greed for jewels leads her to cheat him (1).	1+1
13	She seems to know that Horace will open the safe for her (1) and she keeps up her role as owner until she gets the jewels (1).	1+1
14	Through Horace's polite manner and sneezing (1) and the surprise of a thief being robbed (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The woman looks like a lady of the house and Horace believes it. A true owner would not ask a burglar for help. Appearances can hide a lie.	1+1+1
16	Greed for books leads to the robbery. Trust leads him to open the safe. His fingerprints lead to arrest. The chain makes the moral clear.	1+1+1
17	Horace's greed for books leads to crime and loss of freedom. The woman's greed makes her cheat. Both are shown as weaknesses.	1+1+1
	OR: He could have left no prints and refused to help a stranger. He could have questioned her story. Greater caution would have saved him.	1+1+1
18	A rich house with a safe, at night, with the owner away. The quiet setting suits a secret crime. The prison library gives a contrasting setting at the end.	1+1+1
	OR: She is bold, quick and sceptical. Horace is kindly and trusting. The difference decides who wins.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Trust is the central idea (1). Horace's trust in a stranger (1). The woman's exploitation (1). The question: whom can we trust? (1). Answer: be careful (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Place and time (1). Details of the theft (1). Statements by the owner (1). Police action (1).	2+2+1
20	Horace is alone and sneezing (1). The sound of a visitor (1). The woman's calm entry (1). The decision to open the safe (1). The unexpected result (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He broke the law (1). Fingerprints proved it (1). He was also tricked (1). The punishment was mild and ironic (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 13: **A Question of Trust (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** it adds humour and raises the risk	Comic and tense.
2	**(b)** she wanted them for herself	She stole them.
3	**(c)** one that is hard to find and valuable	Rare = uncommon.
4	**(a)** She said that she needed her jewels.	Backshift.
5	**(c)** light and ironic	Gentle humour.
6	**(b)** he steals only for a gentle passion and is kind	A mild thief.
7	**(a)** careful planning and gullible trust	A central contrast.
8	**(a)** should	'Should have' for past duty.
9	**(d)** Horace's polite helpfulness to a thief	Comic irony.
10	**(d)** The Thief Who Was Robbed	Reflects irony.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He realises he has been fooled (1) and shows a mix of regret and humour rather than anger (1).	1+1
12	A man who earns by locks is tricked (1) and a thief who trusts is robbed by a thief (1).	1+1
13	Whether one should trust a stranger (1) and whether trust can be safely given in suspicious situations (1).	1+1
14	She denies knowledge of Horace (1) and so exposes the young woman as an impostor (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She invented a story quickly and used Horace's own skill. She acted calmly and took the jewels without force. She also left no clues, making Horace the suspect.	1+1+1
16	(a) His fingerprints were found by the police. (b) The door was opened by the woman.	1+1+1
17	The narrator is amused yet sympathetic. He describes Horace's habits with gentle humour. He does not condemn him strongly.	1+1+1
	OR: It gives a comic and gentle end. Horace becomes the prison librarian and finds satisfaction. The reader smiles at his strange luck.	1+1+1
18	(a) What did Horace love? (b) What did the woman take? / Who took the jewels?	1+1+1
	OR: She is clever and calm, a professional thief with no scruples. She makes good use of her chance. She appears charming but heartless.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Horace's lack of verification (1). Consequences (1). Everyday examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greed (1). Gullibility (1). Love of hobbies leading to crime (1). Even a careful person errs (1). Wisdom needs suspicion (1).	2+2+1
20	Introduction (1). Seeing Horace at the safe (1). The decision to play the owner (1). Taking the jewels (1). Escape and thoughts (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Inspector's questions (1). Horace's account (1). The surprising truth (1). End note (1).	2+2+1

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